



ONLINE Vs OFFLINE



In the midst of the biggest brushfire event in human history 'til date – Have we succumbed?

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Every new era in human development has had a certain pattern with respect to the reaction of the people to change. Compared to historical events like the Crusades, the Restoration era, the Renaissance and (to be very honest about it) the rebel ages of Rock music, the acceptance of the Digital Era has been a brushfire event in human history. The part of technology that has had the widest impact is the internet and all that it brought in tow. However, is totally digital and online really better?

Face vs Facebook

Chances are it's Facebook, but Google+ or whatever your choice of online social networking also works here. Where does one draw the line between social convenience and near OCD-ish obsession? As a tool, cyber networking can be very useful. When utility crosses the line into a reliant necessity, maybe it's time to worry. On a positive note, LinkedIn is one website that has refrained from straying too far from its original goal as a professional networking website. But a silver lining does not a nailless coffin make. The bottom line? Ask anyone, and they'll tell you that they'd still rather meet in person.

Score: Online: 0 - Offline: 1

<http://onlineshoppingforjunkyoudontneed.com>

An addiction in itself, online shopping is fast taking over from physical shopping. It's cheaper... the convenience of ordering what you want from the comfort of your home is impossible to compete with. No long lines to pay, no sweaty and rude crowds at discount stores. No pushing, no shoving... Wondering why shops exist at all anymore? There is the small matter of touch and feel. No matter how digitised



Is the future of data in the clouds?

some of us are, there are still many more who just love the experience of being out doors, bargaining, inhaling smog on a roadside and when coupled with actual friends, can be an unbeatable experience. We're a stingy bunch though, so Online had us at "cheaper"...

Score: Online: 1 - Offline: 1

Games vs sports

Not all of us are blessed with hand-eye co-ordination. Heck, for some of us, digital games are the only way to compete with others without getting a nosebleed. To each his own, and we certainly don't endorse indoor-only gamers. A little sunshine did no one any harm. Since this is dependent more on varying physical and mental attributes of our diverse human race, it's a tie.

Score: Online: 2 / Offline: 2

Cloud storage vs hard drives

This one depends on the type of data actually. Your contacts and email? Cloud obviously. Does anyone actually POP3 their mails to Outlook anymore? Music preferences, streaming media, even documents and presentations, cloud obviously

again. However, for your pirated movie collection and C:\Users\<username>\Downloads\Innocent\Folder\Name\to\store\innocently\named\files\that\you\do_not\want_others\to_see\videos.rar you might want a local hard drive. The problem is one of filesize, and also how often you need to access the file, from where, etc. Cloud loses on two points: it needs an internet connection and cannot be used for large files. Since we've seen our lives change drastically in the digital age, and the need to access our data from anywhere is growing, as are internet speeds even in India, cloud wins here.

Score: Online: 3 / Offline: 2

e-Learning vs Traditional Education

With the raise in the internet bar comes the opportunity to change educational trends. e-Learning has picked up. The popularity of the Khan Academy is proof of the same. Sure, traditional learning methods have the advantage of the experience, But unfortunately for traditional education, The advantage of reach and the support of tech advancement that e-Learning holds is hard to be denied. Especially with virtual reality becoming more of a reality, Imagine attending interactive lectures by sitting on a chair at home and popping on the Oculus Rift. Attending lectures at prime universities around the world as a member of a virtual classroom, interacting with the greatest scholars in the world at ease. A step towards global literacy.

Score: Online: 4 / Offline: 2

And the winner is...

Well, clearly the scoreboard speaks for itself. Online tech shall prevail, in all its glory. The future is almost here. **■**